



THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

A Human-Controlled Governance Framework
for Agentic AI in Internal Audit

4 STAGES: Risk → Audit → Evidence → Reporting

✓ CONCEPTUAL RESEARCH FRAMEWORK



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Creator of
THE FUTURIST'S
STRATEGY CONE™



Designed for Boards, CFOs & CAEs
to Govern Agentic AI with Confidence



AI Enhances Capability.
Humans Maintain Accountability.



Explore the
Framework
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DM "CONE" for Framework

Agentic AI Governance: Building Responsible Autonomy with Human Accountability | THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™ V3.0

Agentic AI can enhance organizational capability, but governance authority, risk ownership, accountability, and assurance responsibility remain with appropriate human governance and assurance functions.

Update: V3.0 of THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

Following valuable peer feedback and professional dialogue, the framework has been further strengthened to address critical governance questions surrounding Agentic AI, responsible autonomy, AI risk management, and human accountability.

Key governance principles:

- ◆ Internal Audit & AI Governance

The framework clarifies that Internal Audit may provide independent insights, professional challenge, and advisory perspectives on AI governance considerations without assuming management responsibility. Internal Audit's independence and objectivity remain preserved for assurance activities.

- ◆ Risk-Based AI Autonomy

The level of Agentic AI autonomy is established through documented, risk-based governance decisions aligned with organizational objectives, approved risk appetite, materiality, complexity, validation requirements, oversight mechanisms, and escalation criteria.

- ◆ AI Capability & Human Decision-Making

Agentic AI may support defined analytical activities, assessments, and operational processes where demonstrated effectiveness, appropriate controls, validation, monitoring, and governance oversight have been established. Appropriate governance bodies determine where AI, humans, or a combination of both are appropriate based on risk, objectives, complexity, and accountability requirements.

- ◆ Human Accountability in AI Governance
Accountability, oversight, and decision authority remain with designated accountable executives, management, committees, and governing bodies. Risk ownership, governance responsibility, and accountability cannot be transferred to an AI system.

- ◆ Principles-Based AI Governance Framework

THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

remains grounded in enterprise governance principles, accountability, risk management, control effectiveness, transparency, and human oversight rather than technology-driven rules alone.

Goal: Enable responsible AI innovation with clear accountability.

THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

Reimagining Internal Audit for the Age of Agentic AI



By **Adnan Shamim**